

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

9th edition • Based on GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated projects

Methodology

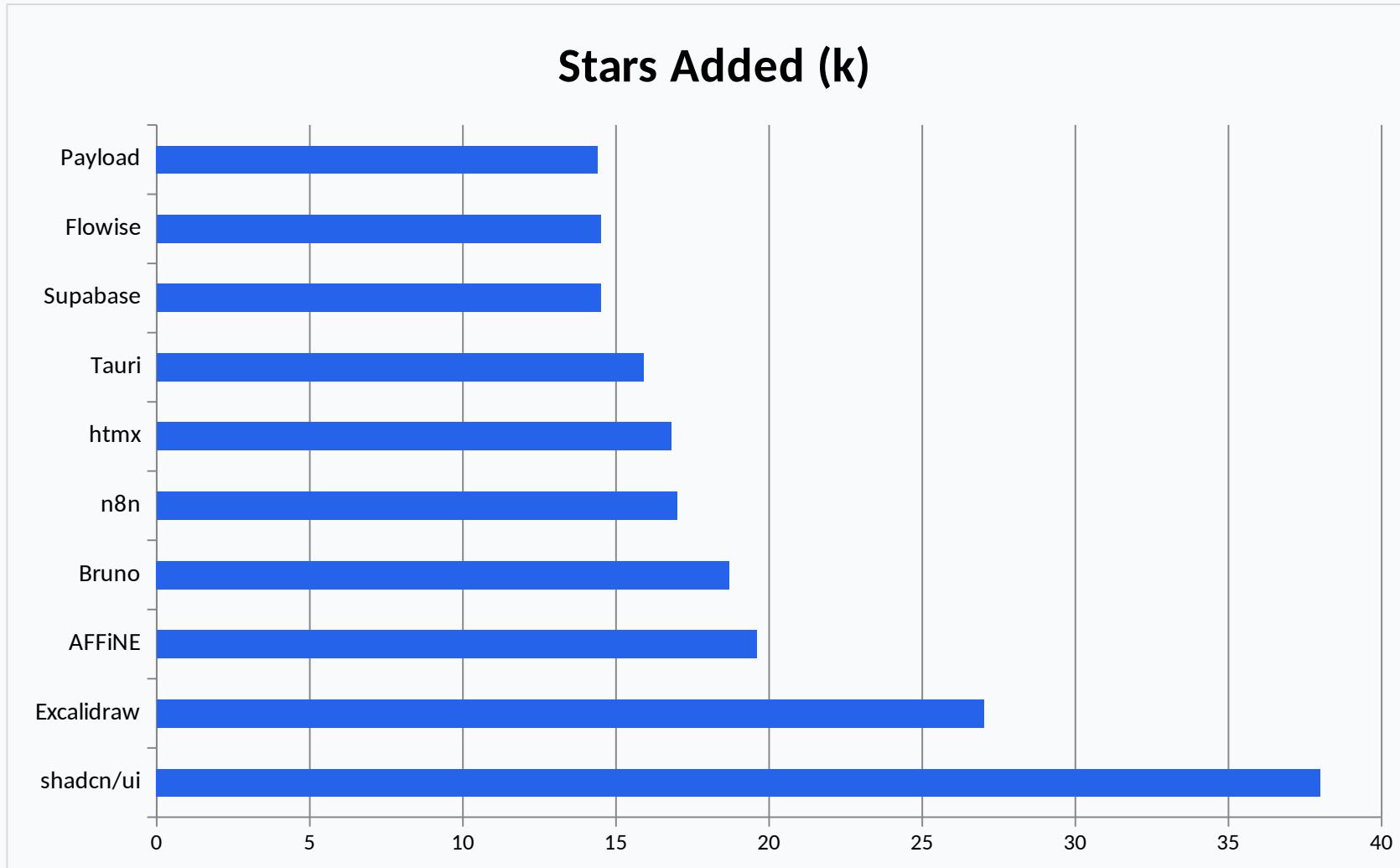
- Metric: net GitHub stars added during calendar year 2024
- Scope: JavaScript projects curated by Best of JS
- Purpose: signal where developer attention and momentum shifted

Audience

- Frontend engineers and engineering managers tracking ecosystem direction

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars

Top 10 JavaScript projects by stars added in 2024



Gap highlight

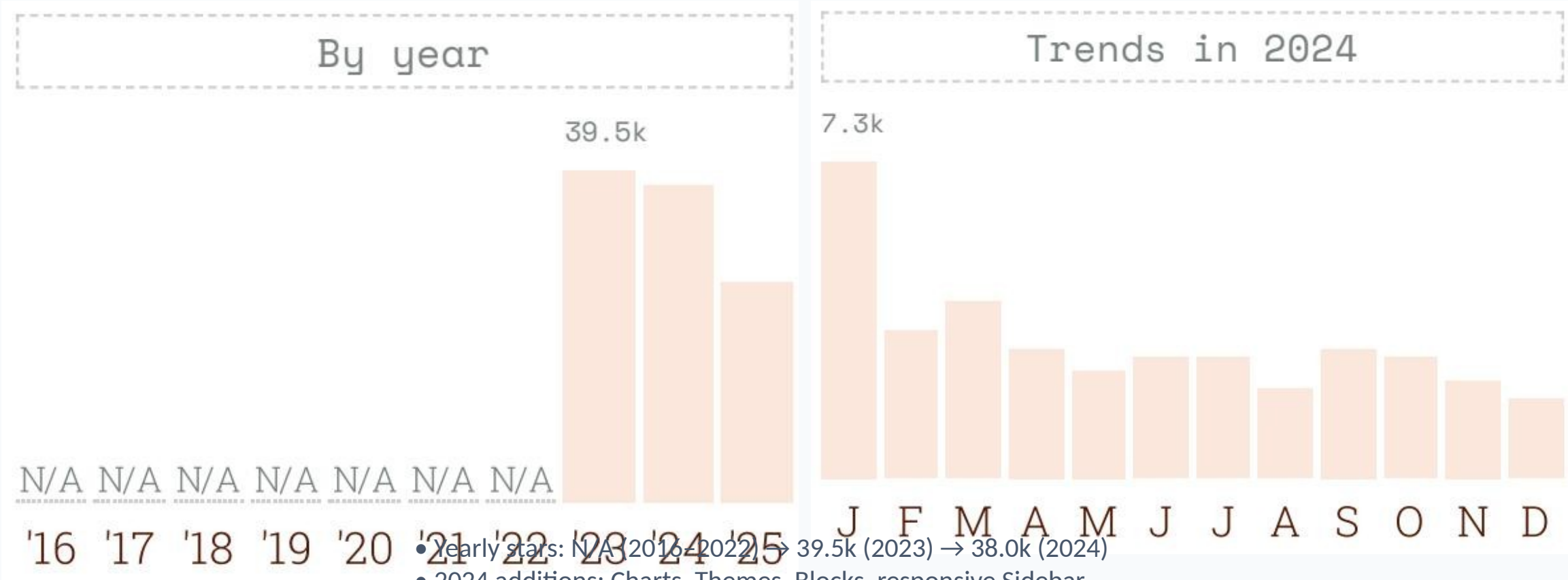
#1 shadcn/ui: 38.0k

#2 Excalidraw: 27.0k

Lead: +11.0k stars

shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win Again

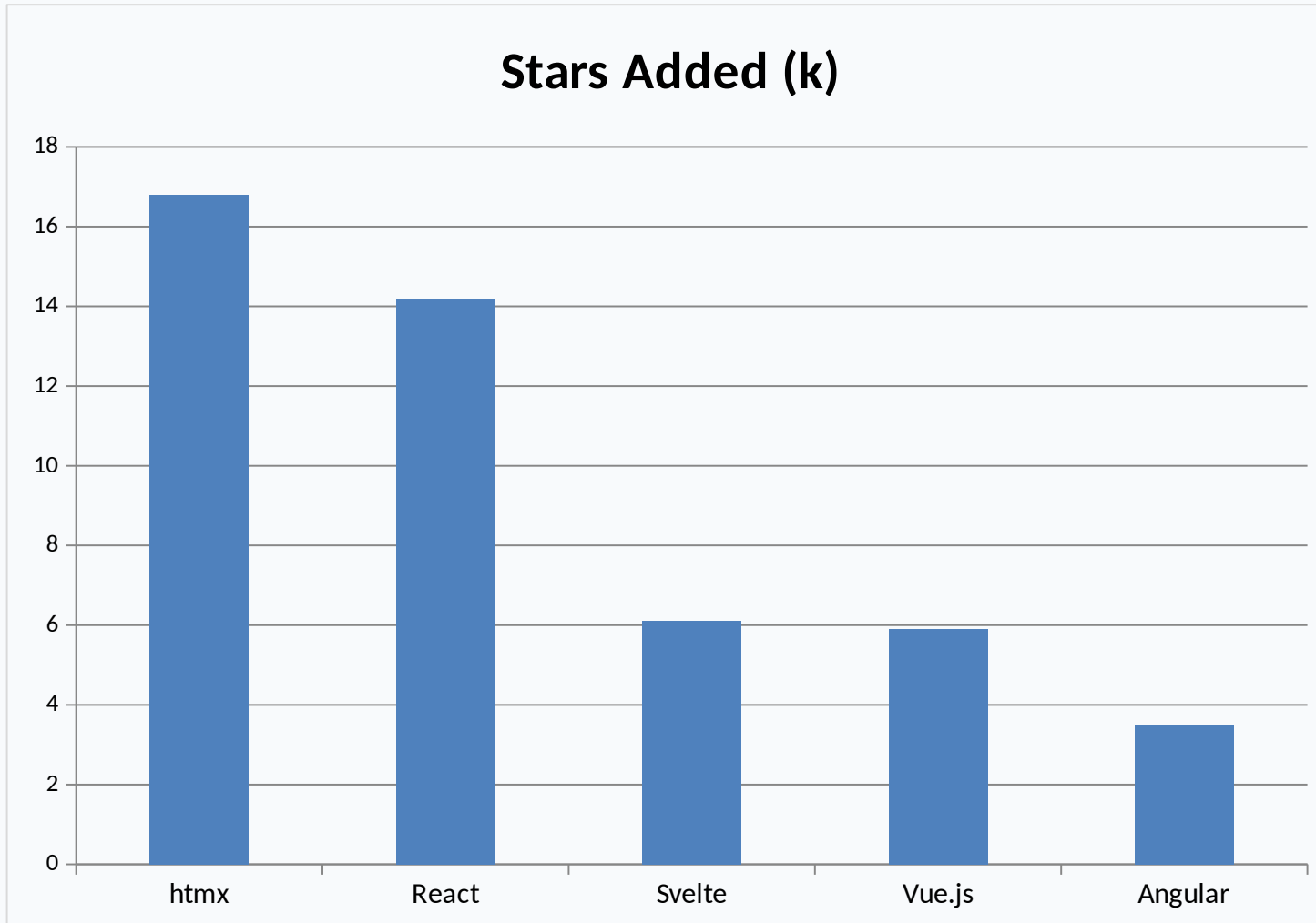
Back-to-back #1 with sustained momentum



- Yearly stars: N/A (2016-2022) → 39.5k (2023) → 38.0k (2024)
- 2024 additions: Charts, Themes, Blocks, responsive Sidebar
- New CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos + registry imports
- Ecosystem effects: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI, and v0 integration

htmx Overtakes React in Front-end Framework Stars Added

2024 ranking by stars added



Interpretation

- htmx: HTML extension via hx-* attributes
- React 19 (Dec 2024): Server Components, Server Functions, new hooks/forms
- Signal: server-driven + progressive enhancement architectures are mainstream

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, Payload Lead

Top 5 React ecosystem projects by stars added in 2024

Project	Stars Added
shadcn/ui	+38.0k
Excalidraw	+27.0k
Payload	+14.4k
Magic UI	+13.2k
Next.js	+12.1k

What this means

- React increasingly behaves like a framework specification
- Server Components/Functions shift architecture decisions to frameworks
- Strong UI + full-stack tooling capture most ecosystem attention

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes with Nuxt, PrimeVue, Slidev

Top 5 Vue ecosystem projects by stars added in 2024

Project	Stars Added
Nuxt	+6.2k
PrimeVue	+5.4k
Slidev	+4.7k
shadcn-vue	+4.1k
VitePress	+3.7k

Ecosystem signals

- Vue 3.5 reactivity rework underway with alien-signals approach
- UI library momentum (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) indicates maturity
- Nuxt’s active release cadence sustains platform confidence

AI, Desktop, and Browser Innovation Define 2024

Cross-cutting themes across rising JavaScript projects

AI & Automation

- n8n +17.0k
- Flowise +14.5k
- Supabase +14.5k

Desktop Expansion

- Tauri +15.9k
- Web frontend for desktop/mobile apps

Browser-native Compute

- PGlite (Postgres in WebAssembly)
- WebVM (VM in browser)

Key Takeaways for 2025 Planning

What frontend engineers and managers should do next

- 1) Prioritize component ownership patterns for design-system velocity.**
- 2) Evaluate HTML-first/server-driven architectures where complexity permits.**
- 3) Treat React as framework-level architecture, not just a UI library choice.**
- 4) Make AI integration a baseline capability in developer workflows and products.**
- 5) Watch Vue ecosystem momentum: mature UI tooling lowers adoption risk.**

Forward look: 2025 competition will center on DX ecosystems, AI-native workflows, and browser-capability leverage.